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APPS



As the browser wars heat up, here are the hottest alternatives to Chrome and Safari in 2025

Google Chrome and Apple's Safari currently dominate the web browser market, with Chrome holding a significant share due to the tech giant's ongoing innovations, particularly in integrating generative AI into its search functionalities.

However, users seeking alternatives will find a variety of browsers aiming to challenge these industry giants.

To help navigate the competitive landscape of the browser wars, we've compiled an overview of some of the top alternative browsers available today. This includes browsers leveraging AI, open source browsers that promote customization and privacy, and "mindful browsers" — a new term that refers to browsers designed to enhance user well-being.

## AI-powered browsers

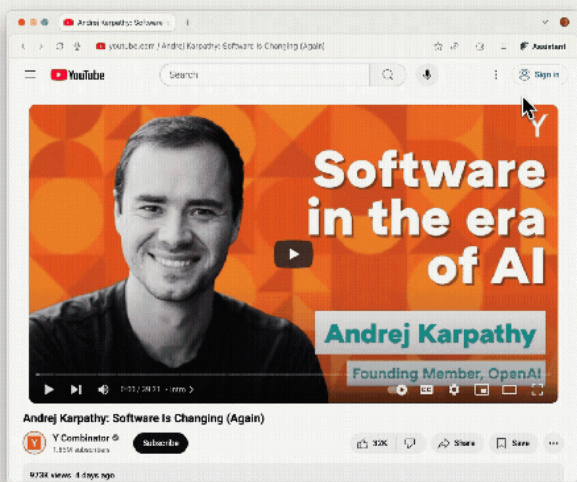


IMAGE CREDITS: PERPLEXITY

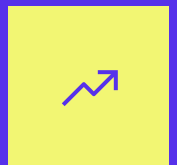
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# Perplexity's Comet

Perplexity is the most recent startup in the space to [launch an AI-powered web browser](#). Called [Comet](#), the company's new product acts as a chatbot-based search engine, and can perform actions like summarizing emails, browsing web pages, and performing tasks such as sending calendar invites. It's currently only available to users with Perplexity's \$200/month Max plan, but there's also a waitlist where people can sign up.

## The Browser Company's Dia

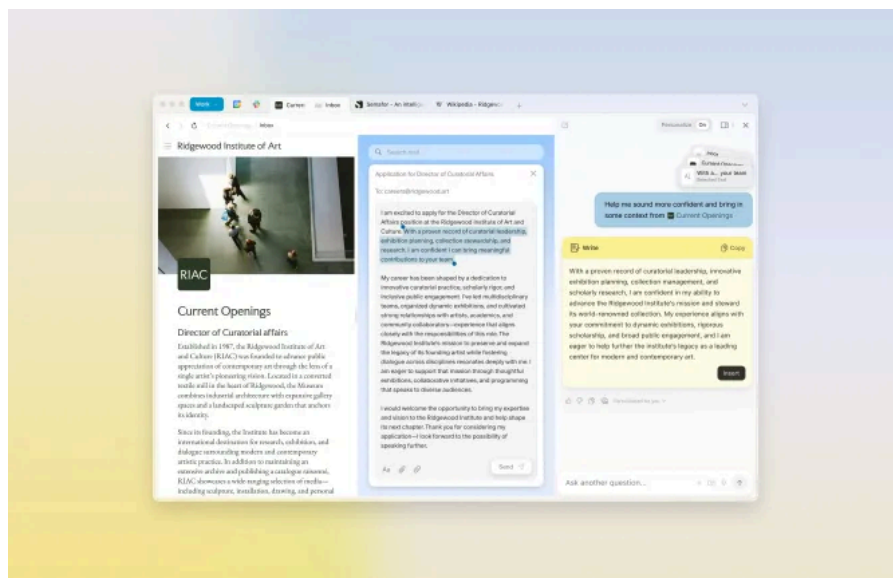


IMAGE CREDITS: THE BROWSER COMPANY

The Browser Company, the startup behind the Arc browser, [recently introduced Dia](#), its AI-centric browser that looks similar to Google Chrome but with an AI chat tool.

Currently available as an [invite-only beta](#), Dia is designed to help users navigate the web more easily. It's able to look at every website that a user has visited and every website they're logged into, enabling it to help you find information and perform tasks. For instance, Dia can provide information about the page a user is currently browsing, answer questions about a product, and summarize uploaded files.

- Lina Khan points to Figma IPO as vindication of M&A scrutiny
- Your public ChatGPT queries are getting indexed by Google and other search engines

To get early access to Dia, users have to be an Arc member. Non-members can join the waitlist.

## Opera's Neon

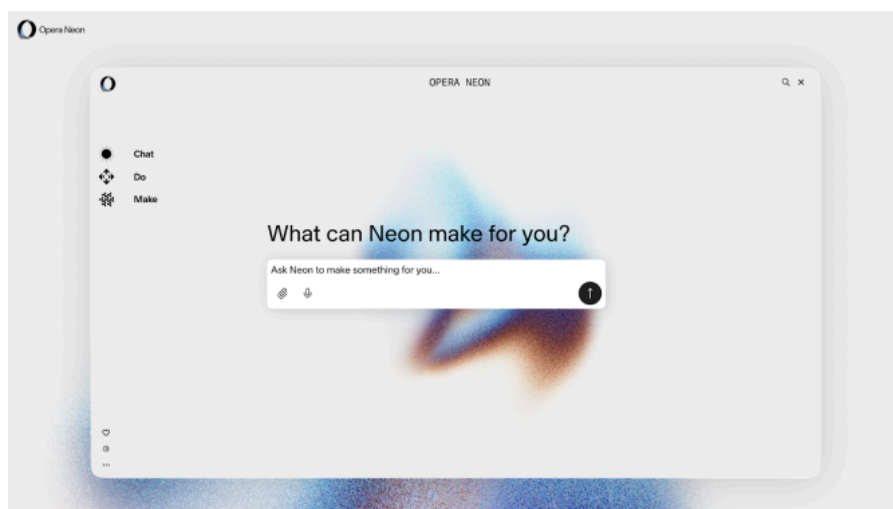


IMAGE CREDITS: OPERA

Another [recent entry](#) into the AI agentic browser war is Opera's [Neon](#), which has contextual awareness and can do things like researching, shopping, and writing snippets of code. Notably, it can even perform tasks while the user is offline.

Neon has yet to become available, but people can join the waitlist. It will be a subscription product; however, Opera hasn't announced pricing yet.

## OpenAI's rumored browser

According to Reuters, [OpenAI](#) may also be releasing an AI-powered web browser [as soon as July](#). The browser is reported to operate inside ChatGPT, letting users browse websites inside the chatbot instead of directing to outside links.

## Privacy-focused browsers

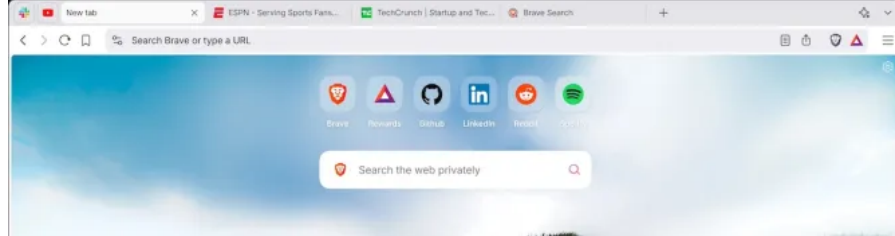


IMAGE CREDITS: BRAVE

## Brave

[Brave](#) is among the more well-known [privacy-first browsers](#), popular for its built-in ad and tracker blocking capabilities. It also has a gamified approach to browsing, rewarding users with its own cryptocurrency called Basic Attention Token (BAT). When users choose to opt in to view ads, supporting their favorite websites, they get a share of the ad revenue. Additional features include a VPN service, [an AI assistant](#), and [a video calling feature](#).

## DuckDuckGo

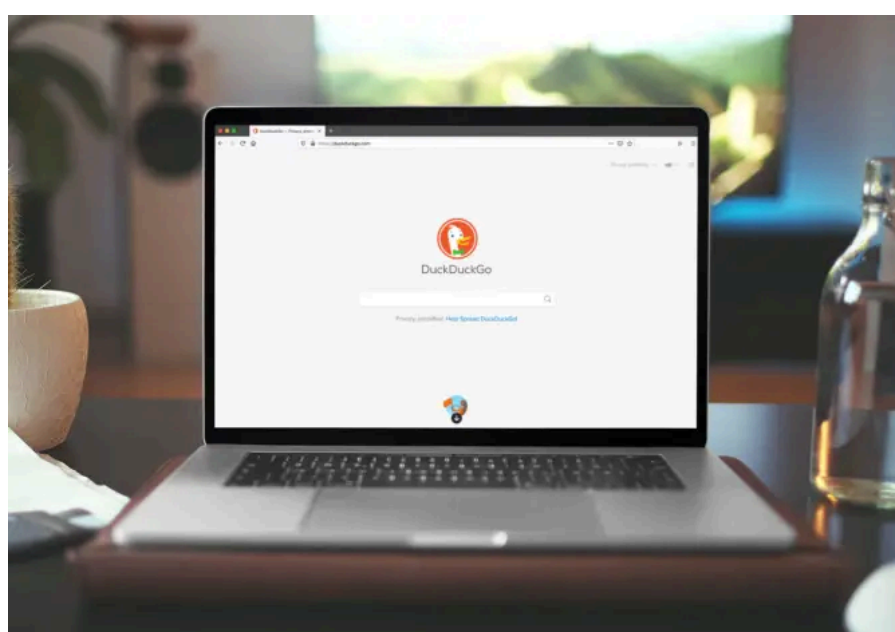


IMAGE CREDITS: DUCKDUCKGO

[DuckDuckGo](#) is another [browser](#) that many people are probably already familiar with, thanks to its search engine by the same name. Launched in 2008, the company recently made significant investments in its browser to stay competitive by [introducing generative AI features](#), such as a

chatbot. It also [enhanced its scam blocker](#) to detect a wider range of scams, including fake cryptocurrency exchanges, scareware tactics, and fraudulent e-commerce websites. In addition to blocking scams, DuckDuckGo prevents trackers and ads, and it doesn't track user data, resulting in fewer pop-ups for users.

## Ladybird

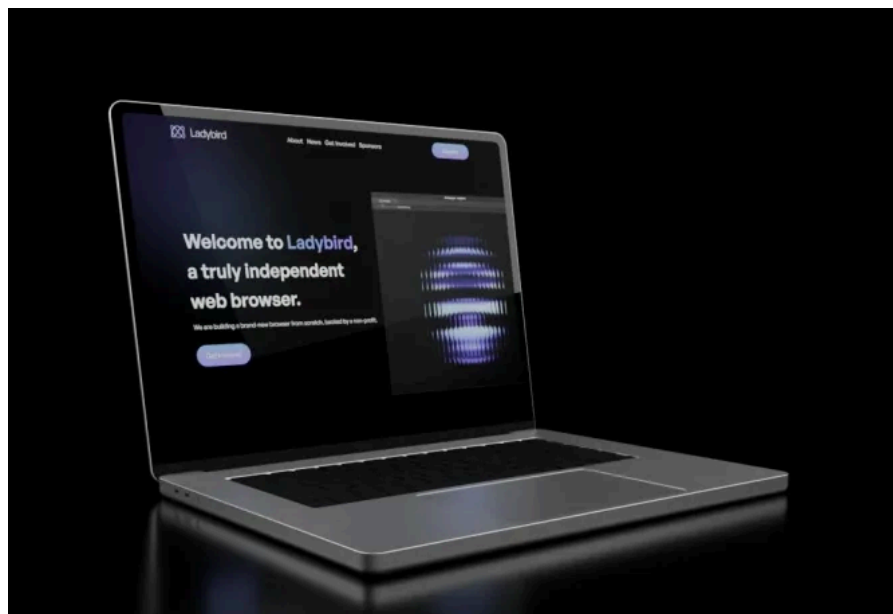


IMAGE CREDITS: LADYBIRD

[Ladybird](#), led by GitHub co-founder and former CEO Chris Wanstrath, has an ambitious mission compared to other rivals: it aims to build an entirely new open source browser from scratch. This means it will not rely on code from existing browsers, a feat that has rarely been accomplished. Most alternative web browsers depend on the Chromium open source project maintained by Google, which is the most widely used base for many browsers.

Like other privacy-focused browsers, Ladybird will offer features to minimize data collection, such as a built-in ad blocker and the ability to block third-party cookies. The browser has yet to be launched, with an alpha version scheduled for release in 2026 for early adopters, available on Linux and macOS.

# Vivaldi

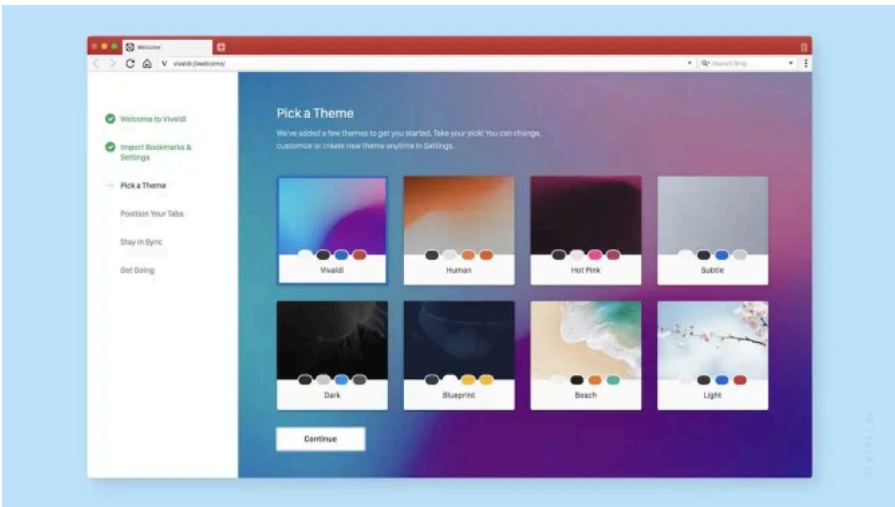


IMAGE CREDITS:VIVALDI

Vivaldi is a Chromium-based browser created by one of the original developers of the Opera browser. Its biggest selling point is its customizable user interface, which allows users to change the appearance and enable or disable features. One unique feature is that the browser window changes color to match the website being viewed. Other key features include ad blocking, a password manager, no user data tracking, and productivity tools such as a calendar and notes.

## Niche browsers

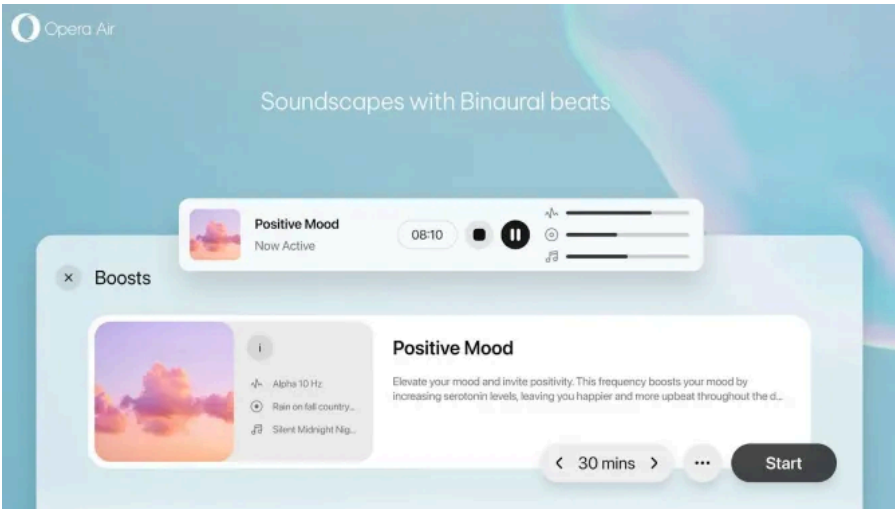


IMAGE CREDITS:OPERA

# Opera Air

Opera [launched](#) the Air browser in February, becoming one of the first mindfulness-themed browsers in the space. While [Opera Air](#) functions like a typical web browser, it includes unique features designed to support mental well-being. These features consist of break reminders and breathing exercises. Another feature, called “Boosts,” provides a selection of binaural beats to either help improve focus or relaxation.

## SigmaOS

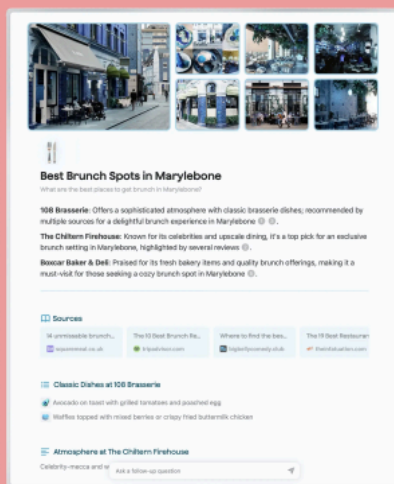


IMAGE CREDITS: SIGMAOS

[SigmaOS](#) is a Mac-only browser featuring a workspace-style interface that emphasizes productivity. It displays tabs vertically, allowing users to treat them like a to-do list that can be marked as complete or snoozed for later. Users can create workspaces — essentially groups of tabs — to better organize different activities, such as separating work from entertainment.

This Y Combinator-backed browser has [been around](#) for a few years now and has most recently begun introducing more [AI features](#), including the ability to summarize various elements of a web page, such as ratings, reviews, and prices. It also has an [AI assistant](#) that can answer questions, translate text, and rewrite content.

SigmaOS is free to use, but users who want more than three workspaces can subscribe to a plan for \$8 per month, which provides unlimited workspaces.

## Zen Browser

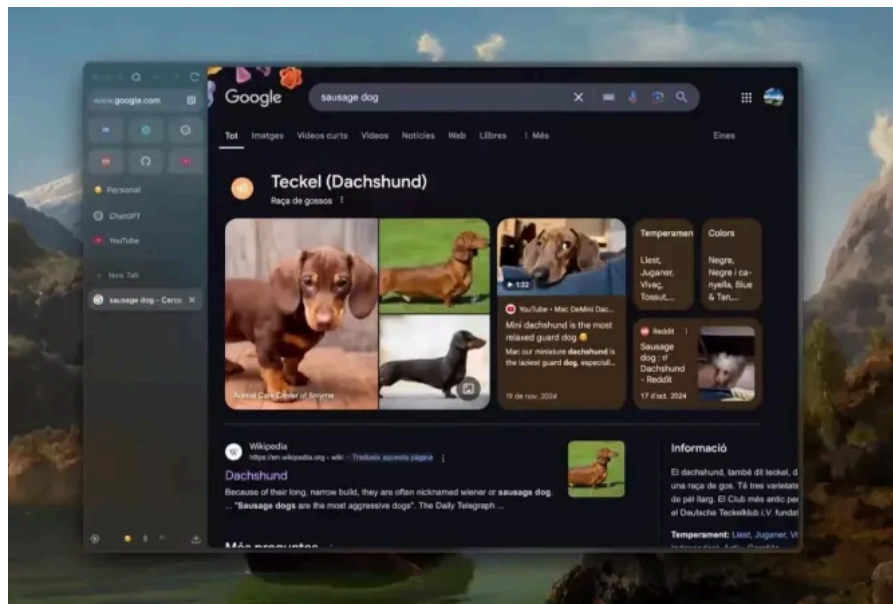


IMAGE CREDITS:ZEN BROWSER

[Zen Browser](#) aims to create a “calmer internet” with its open source browser. Zen lets users organize tabs into Workspaces, and offers Split View to view two tabs side by side, among other productivity-focused features. Users can also enhance their browsing experience with community-made plug-ins and themes, such as a mod that makes the tab background transparent.

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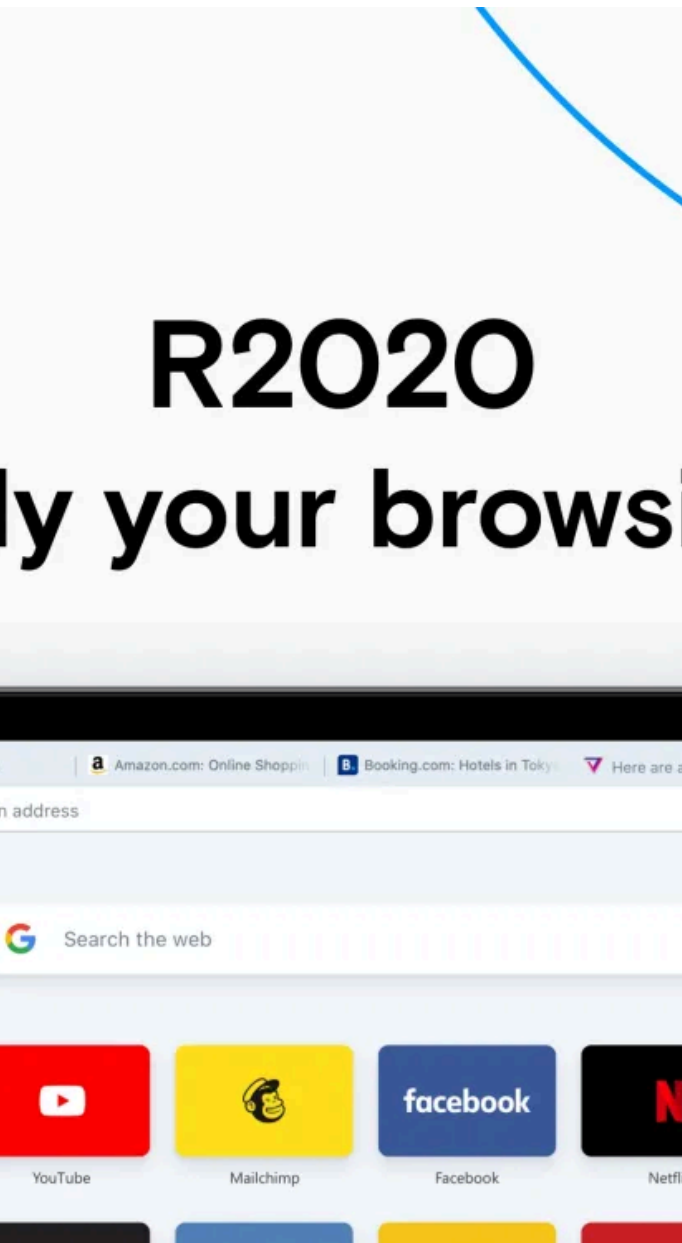
**Lauren Forristal**



Lauren covers media, streaming, apps and platforms at TechCrunch.

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## Opera's new browser can tame your tabs

Sarah Perez — 8:42 AM PST · February 25, 2020

A new web browser from Opera launching today aims to help users get their chaotic mess of open tabs back under control. In the [latest release of Opera's desktop browser](#) (codenamed R2020), the company is introducing a new feature called "Workspaces" that allows you to organize your tabs based on different contexts — for example,

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workspaces for work, free time activities, personal projects, research, travel planning and more.

Today, it's common for web users to keep open dozens of tabs — and even multiple separate windows, each filled with tabs — as an attempt to keep their web searches and research somewhat organized. This is particularly tough for knowledge workers who spend their days working from a PC or for the 66% of Americans who use the same browser for work and personal browsing, Opera says.

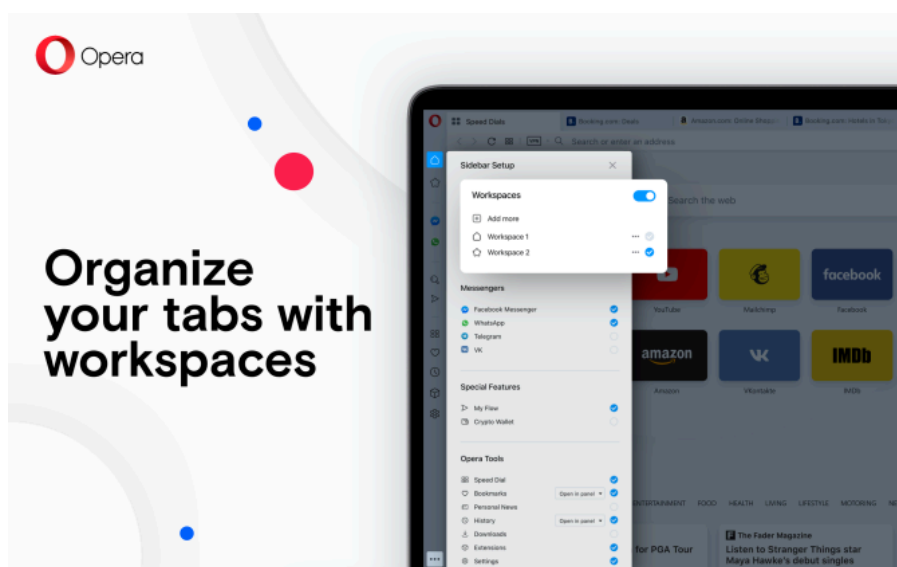
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Opera's study also found that 65% of people want to keep their browser more organized and 60% wanted to be able to group tabs.



Unfortunately, major browser makers have still not effectively addressed these problems, instead leaving users to design their own productivity solutions or to turn to third-party browser add-ons for help with organization.

For example, the browser extension [OneTab](#) lets you quickly close and save all your open tabs for

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later access. However, because extensions like this aren't part of the core browser experience, many users don't know they exist. And even if you do use an extension to aid with organization, it's easy to forget you've saved your tabs somewhere — often, you'll just search up the same pages again instead of restoring them.

Opera's system instead presents the concept of the workspace as a means of taming your numerous open tabs. You can create up to five workspaces in the new browser, name them and designate their icons. The icons are accessible from the top of the sidebar, with the currently active workspace highlighted in blue.

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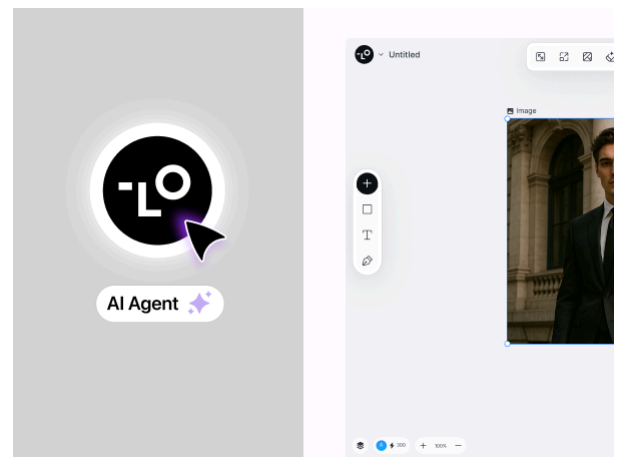
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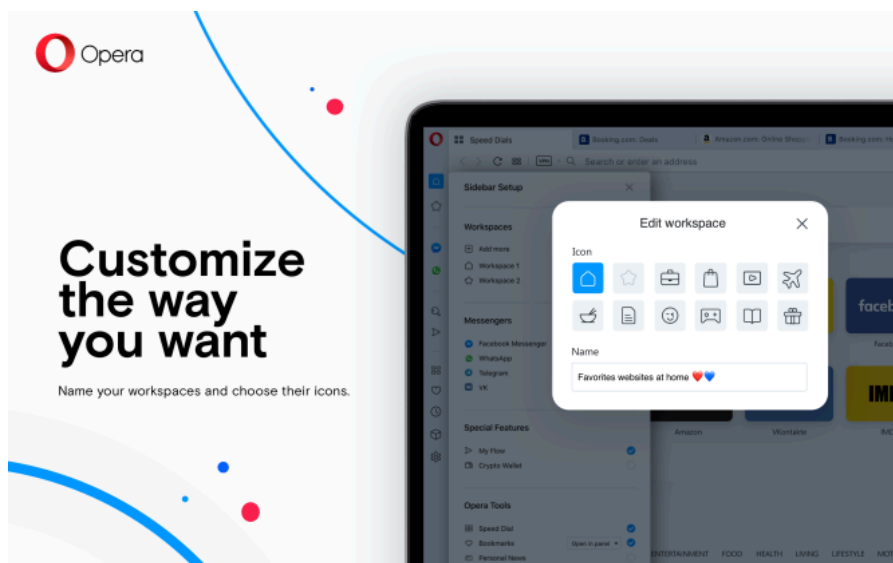
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You can also right-click any link to open it in a different workspace and move tabs between workspaces easily, the company says. That can help users not just start off organized but stay organized, especially since people tend to switch back and forth between contexts as they work. For example, users may take a few minutes to check on personal messages and social networks in between typing into online spreadsheets and responding to work emails.



“Opera invented browser tabs, and today we know that people need more support from their browser interface to handle them,” said Joanna Czajka, product director, Opera for PC, in a statement about the launch. “Everybody wants their environment to be more tidy, ideally without having to clean. Workspaces let you get organized from the first moment you use them, without you having to learn how to use a new tool.”

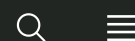


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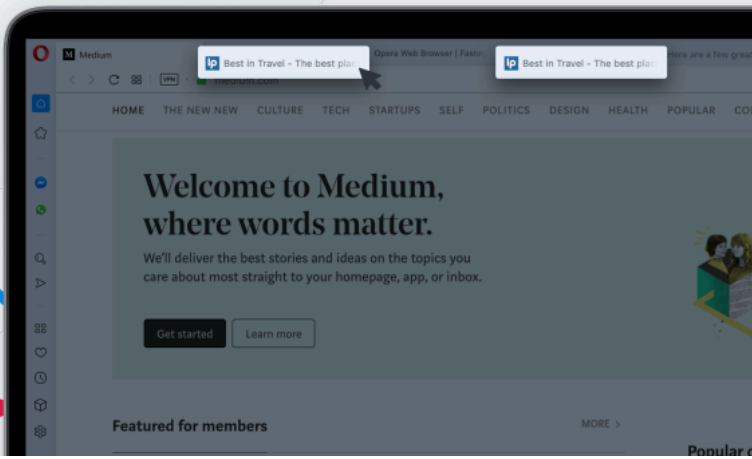
While Workspaces is the major new feature in the beta browser, another addition lets you switch between open tabs easily by using the keyboard shortcut Ctrl + Tab — similar to switching applications on macOS. And a third new tool will

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Opera is well-known for its browser innovations, but many of its latest releases have been more focused on technology integrations, [like the built-in cryptocurrency wallet](#) or VPN. It has also released tools designed to protect privacy, like [the tracker blocker](#), and [debuted a browser for gamers](#), Opera GX. But it hasn't been as focused on the day-to-day needs of browser users as of late.



Unfortunately, switching browsers can be more difficult these days since smaller browsers and beta builds don't always support the variety of extensions users rely on.

Nevertheless, Opera claims its browser user base is growing. Its PC browser user base grew 17% from Q3 2018 to Q3 2019, the company says, reaching now more than 68 million monthly users.

The browser is [a free download here.](#)



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**Sarah Perez**

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Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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# Opera Sings The Final Song With Its Rendering Engine, Decides To Shift To WebKit



Opera is that company that everyone knows about but never really stopped to understand why it is so important. The Norway-based company has always been an ankle-biter, pushing the envelope and calling out the big guys for injustices put upon web developers and Internet surfers. It's not a sexy position to be in, but Opera has always stood its ground.

Today, Opera has announced that it will be slowly abandoning its own web-rendering "Turbo" engine in lieu of



WebKit, the core development platform used by Chrome and Safari. In a way, today is a sad day. The company might have fallen on its own sword for the greater good, one final time.

By never having the pole position in the “browser war,” Opera had the freedom to try new things and make noise about the issues that really matter, including being able to choose your default browser on the desktop. There was a time when Microsoft PC users had no option of which browser to use; Internet Explorer came bundled with the operating system. It was an anti-trust situation — a monopoly if you will. Opera stood up and fought.

How hard has it fought? Here's a quote from then-CEO of Opera, Jon von Tetzchner, from a 2007 press

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[release](#) which announced Opera's EU anti-trust complaint against Microsoft:

We are filing this complaint on behalf of all consumers who are tired of having a monopolist make choices for them. In addition to promoting the free choice of individual consumers, we are a champion of open Web standards and cross-platform innovation. We cannot rest until we've brought fair and equitable options to consumers worldwide.

This quote is what Opera stands for, and with today's announcement, a little bit of Opera died. Von Tetzchner [left the company in 2011](#) and the company became decreasingly aggressive in the years after. When von Tetzchner left, he sent a very strong-worded and poignant email describing how things had fallen apart:

It has become clear that The Board, Management and I do not share the same values and we do not have the same opinions on how to keep evolving Opera.

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From its own blog post, you can tell how hard this decision was to make, as it was something that was better for users and developers, both of whom Opera cares deeply about:

On the same day as announcing that Opera has 300 million users, we're also announcing that for all new products Opera will use WebKit as its rendering engine and V8 as its JavaScript engine. It's built using the open-source Chromium browser as one of its components. Of course, a browser is much more than just a renderer and a JS engine, so this is primarily an "under the hood" change.

Consumers will initially notice better site compatibility, especially with mobile-facing sites — many of which have only been tested in WebKit browsers. The first product will be for Smartphones, which we'll demonstrate at Mobile World Congress in Barcelona at the end of the month. Opera Desktop and other products will transition later.

Opera has always pushed so hard to make its browser fast, as if to make the web sing for people all over the world, no matter what type of device they're on. The company has also made tabbed browsing something we're all used to, by making it faster than everyone else did at the time. By choosing to develop its product on top of WebKit, it is, in essence, giving up. It's not a stretch to say that

Google was able to pass Microsoft with its Chrome browser because all of the work that Opera has put into the space, tirelessly fighting for more cross-platform friendliness and putting an end to a No. 1-by-default situation.

A sentiment of sadness is being shared by developers and former Opera employees:

[tweet  
<https://twitter.com/annevk/status/301605909619150848>]

However, not everyone is crying about the move, considering the fact that if Opera can bring its tenacity to developing for WebKit, everyone wins. Sr. Director of User Interface Engineering at PayPal, Bill Scott, shared these thoughts with us:

I am a big fan of webkit because I am focused on the user's experience more than I am with being a standards purist. I know that some of my colleagues feel like that we as web developer's failed because we did not ensure all of our experiences worked on Opera. But what they forget is that this is a marketplace. Companies can only reasonably test on just a few platforms. At the end of the day our users shouldn't have to pay for our fractured platforms. In no other software area do we have to deal with this many "standards". Moving closer to a single platform means we can spend more time building experiences rather than showing off our encyclopedic knowledge of browser variants to one another.

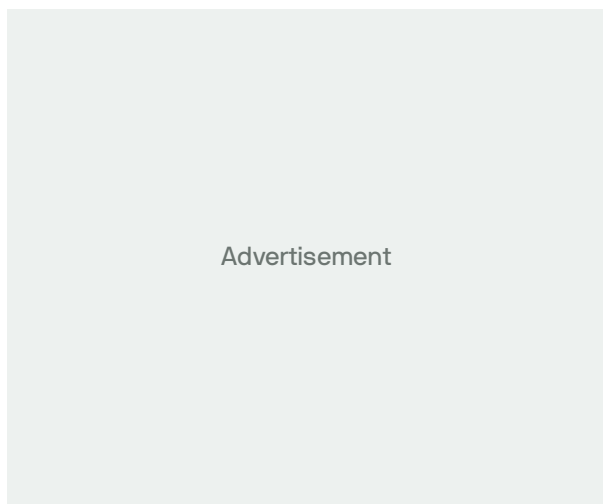
Netflix took the approach in late 2009 to settle on webkit as their SDK for all TV experiences which folded nicely into mobile & tablet strategy (by and large this is webkit). I know that the web team there had some browser envy since the TV team could just code for webkit. But being able to settle on webkit really made development move a lot faster.

If we can take the talent of the Opera team and apply it to webkit this will be a big win. And if we could just get IE to switch then we will have arrived at near-nirvana.

The tide has turned today, but we know that without Opera’s work on keeping browsers speedy and open, yet standarized, there wouldn’t be a Firefox or a Chrome or any other alternative browser. The “nirvana” that Scott mentions is a place where developers know exactly what they’re coding for, without worry that they’ll have to refactor everything for a completely different platform. If Microsoft were to shift to WebKit, you can thank Opera. Again.

[Photo credit: [Seattle PI](#)]

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## Drew Olanoff

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Drew is a geek who first worked at AOL when he was 16 years old. Drew was a senior writer at TechCrunch. Most...

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